INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-32606
16 August 2018
SUPERSEDING
(See 6.4)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BANDOLEERS FOR
CARTRIDGES: 5.56MM and 7.62MM AMMUNITION

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements and verification methods of the four (4) types of Bandoleers for use in 5.56mm and 7.62mm Ammunition: M2, M4, M8, and M249.

1.2 Classification. Bandoleers are of the following types:

M2 Bandoleer is intended to hold 7.62mm ammunition in 5 round clips for use in 7.62mm rifles.

M4 Bandoleer is intended to hold 100 round belts of 7.62mm linked ammunition in a carton for use in a 7.62mm machine gun.

M8 Bandoleer is intended to hold 5.56mm ammunition in 10 round clips for use in 5.56mm rifles.

M249 Bandoleer is intended to hold 200 round belts of 5.56mm linked ammunition in a magazine for use in a 5.56mm M249 machine gun.

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to: Commander, U.S. Army ARDEC, ATTN: RDAR-EIQ-SA, Picatinny Arsenal, New Jersey 07806-5000 or e-mailed to usarmy.picatinny.ardec.list.ardec-stdzn-branch@mail.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this information using ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

AMSC N/A FSC 1305

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2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

FEDERAL STANDARD

FED-STD-191	–	Textile Test Methods

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-1916	–	DOD Preferred Methods for Acceptance of Product

(Copies of these documents are available online at http://quicksearch.dla.mil/.)

2.2.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

U.S. ARMY ARMAMENT RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT AND ENGINEERING CENTER (ARDEC) DRAWINGS

8594723	–	Bandoleer, M2 (For 7.62mm Cartridges)
9349295	–	Bandoleer, 200 Round Magazine (M249 M.G.)
10533983	–	Details; Bandoleer, M4
11744271	–	Bandoleer, M8

(Copies of these drawings are available from U.S. Army ARDEC, ATTN: RDAR-EIS-PE, Picatinny, NJ 07806-5000, or email usarmy.pica.rdecom-ardec.list.drawing-request-help-desk@mail.mil.)

2.3 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample of the bandoleer shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Conformance inspection. A sample of the bandoleer shall be subjected to conformance inspection in accordance with 4.4.

3.3 Bandoleer. The bandoleer shall comply with the requirements specified on Drawing 8594723, 9349295, 10533983, or 11744271 accordingly, and its components and its assemblies.

3.4 Assemblage. The ammunition magazine or carton shall be capable of being inserted into and removed from the bandoleer. Tearing of the hood, body, strap, stitching, or any other damage is not permitted.

3.5 Strength of material. The bandoleer shall be loaded with a weight, approximating the size and shape of standard packaged ammunition, in accordance with Table I. The bandoleer shall not show any ripping of stitches or material when subjected to a 12 inch free drop with center of strap supporting the bandoleer upon completion of the drop.

TABLE I. Drop test weight.

Bandoleer	Weight
M2	9 ounces ± 0.5 ounces per pocket
M4	6.5 pounds ± 2 ounces
M8	1 pound ± 1 ounces per pocket
M249	7 pounds ± 2 ounces

3.6 M8 slip stitch. The slip stitch shall be easily removable by hand.

3.7 M8 ultrasonic weld. When an ultrasonic seam weld is used, the finished seam shall offer a neat, even appearance. Additionally, there shall be no holes evident when the seam is held up to a light source and the seam shall possess a minimum of 12 pounds bond strength when tested in accordance with prescribed bond strength procedure.

3.8 Workmanship. The bandoleer shall be uniform in appearance and free of defects affecting serviceability.

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4. VERIFICATION

TABLE II. Requirement/verification cross reference matrix.

Method of Verification		Classes of Verification						
1 – Analysis 2 – Demonstration 3 – Examination 4 – Test		A – First article B – Conformance						
Section 3 Requirement	Description	Verification Methods				Verification Class		Section 4 Verification Method
		1	2	3	4	A	B	
3.1	First article			X	X	X		4.1, 4.2, 4.3
3.2	Conformance inspection			X	X		X	4.1, 4.2, 4.4
3.3	Bandoleer			X	X	X	X	4.4.2, Table III
3.4	Assemblage				X	X	X	4.5.1
3.5	Strength of material				X	X	X	4.5.2
3.6	M8 slip stitch		X	X		X	X	4.5.3
3.7	M8 ultrasonic weld			X	X	X	X	4.5.4
3.8	Workmanship			X		X	X	4.5.5

4.1 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3)

b. Conformance inspection (see 4.4)

4.2 Inspection condition. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5.

4.3 First article inspection. When specified, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection in accordance with Table III, Table V, and 4.5.

4.3.1 First article quantity. The first article sample shall consist of the sample quantities indicated in Table III.

4.3.2 Inspections to be performed. The first article inspection shall consist of 100% examination for defects of all drawing requirements including workmanship requirements for the parts and assemblies listed in 4.3.1, and all tests specified in Table III.

4.3.3 First article rejection. If any assembly, component or test specimen fails to comply with requirements, the first article sample shall be rejected.

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TABLE III. First article tests and inspection.

Examination or Test	Conformance Criteria			Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Method Reference
	Qty	Acc	Rej		
Examination for defects	50	0	1	3.3	Table V
Assemblage	12	0	1	3.4	4.5.1
Strength of material	50	0	1	3.5	4.5.2
M8 only					
Slip stitch test	12	0	1	3.6	4.5.3
Ultrasonic weld test 1/	See 4.5.4			3.7	4.5.4
Workmanship	50	0	1	3.8	4.5.5
NOTES: 1/ If applicable					

4.4 Conformance inspection.

4.4.1 Inspection lot formation. Lot formation shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-1916. Unless otherwise specified, component parts shall be homogeneous, inspected, and tested.

4.4.2 Classification of characteristics.

a. Sampling requirements. Unless otherwise specified, Verification Level IV shall be used for all characteristics defined as Majors and Verification Level II for all Minor characteristics.

b. Conformance inspection. Conformance inspection shall be performed in accordance with Table IV and Table V. For all conformance inspections, the same sample specimen may be used for all non-destructive examinations or tests.

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TABLE IV. Conformance tests.

Examination or Test	Conformance Criteria			Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Method Reference
	Qty	Acc	Rej		
Examination for defects				3.3	Table V
Major Gage	VL IV	0	1		
Major Visual 1/					
(1st sample)	192	3	6		
(Cumulative)	576	5	6		
Minor Gage	VL II	0	1		
Minor Visual 1/					
(1st sample)	32	3	6		
(Cumulative)	96	5	6		
Assemblage	12	0	1	3.4	4.5.1
Strength of Material	50	0	1	3.5	4.5.2
M8 only					
Slip stitch test	12	0	1	3.6	4.5.3
Ultrasonic weld test 2/	See 4.5.4			3.7	4.5.4
Workmanship	50	0	1	3.8	4.5.5

NOTES:

1/ Failure of 4 or 5 bandoleers in the first sample shall result in testing of a second sample consisting of double the quantity of the first sample quantity. Failure of the bandoleer in the cumulative sample to comply shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ If Applicable.

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TABLE V. Defect inspections.

Classification	Examination or Test	Conformance Criteria 1/	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Method Reference
Critical	None defined			
Major				
101	Improper stitch type	VL IV	3.3	Visual
102	Skipped, broken or omitted stitching greater than 1/4 inch in length in any single location	VL IV	3.3	Gage
103	Presence of rips and tears	VL IV	3.3	Visual
104	Missing bar tack 2/	VL IV	3.3	Visual
105	Height of bandoleer 3/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
106	Width of pockets 2/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
107	Width of bandoleer 3/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
108	Depth of pockets 2/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
109	Flap, max length 2/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
110	Missing or incomplete slip stitch 5/	VL IV	3.3	Visual
111	Missing or open safety pin 2/	VL IV	3.3	Visual
112	Missing back stitching (type 301)	VL IV	3.3	Visual
113	Ultrasonic bonded seam width not between 5/32 to 5/16 inch 5/	VL IV	3.3	Gage
Minor				
201	Twisted strap	VL II	3.3	Visual
202	Excessive bar tack length 4/	VL II	3.3	Gage
203	Insufficient or excessive stitching per inch	VL II	3.3	Gage
204	Marking missing, illegible, or incorrect	VL II	3.3	Visual
205	Length of carrying strap	VL II	3.3	Gage
206	Length of stitching runoff (tails type 401, 404)	VL II	3.3	Gage
207	Strap intersection dimension 2/	VL II	3.3	Gage
208	Excessive back stitching (type 301)	VL II	3.3	Visual
209	Stain or soil greater than ½ square inch	VL II	3.3	Gage

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TABLE V. Defect inspections– Continued.

Classification	Examination or Test	Conformance Criteria 1/	Requirement Paragraph	Inspection Method Reference
NOTES: 1/ Level II or Level IV respectively of MIL-STD-1916. 2/ M2 and M8 Only. 3/ M4 and M249 Only. Dimensions to be checked after assembly of strap. 4/ M2, M8, M249 Only. 5/ M8 Only.				

4.5 Tests. The following test shall be conducted in accordance with test methods and procedures prescribed in 4.4.

4.5.1 Assemblage. The sample bandoleers, after passing visual inspection, shall be packed with the specified ammunition magazine, point protectors, carton, or Government approved facsimile. The bandoleer top flap (if applicable) shall be pulled over the top of the item to be packed. The bandoleers shall then be disassembled and visually examined for tears. Tearing of the hood, body, strap, stitching, or any other damage is not permitted. Should the sample fail to meet the acceptance criteria as specified, the lot shall be rejected.

4.5.2 Drop test. Each pocket of the test bandoleers shall be filled with a weight as specified in 3.5 approximating the dimensions of the pocket. The filled bandoleer shall be suspended by the strap, with the weight evenly distributed, from a rigid horizontal bar approximately one-half inch diameter. The strap, at the point of suspension, shall then be raised vertically one foot and dropped upon the bar.

4.5.3 M8 slip stitch test. The slip stitch will be removed by pulling the slip stitch thread overhang until the slip stitch is completely removed. No locking of the slip stitch or breaking of the thread shall occur.

4.5.4 M8 bond strength test. Three specimens shall be prepared at a particular machine setting as follows:

a. Using the 65 percent (minimum) synthetic based outer shell material, cut two 12 inch long swatches in the wrap (machine) direction, one 2 inches wide and one 8 inches wide each in the filling (cross machine) direction.

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b. If using a plunge type ultrasonic machine, then use appropriate manufacturer's leveling procedures to assure that the horn is level with the anvil.

c. Use a 5/32 inch (min) wide light knurled faced horn or roller as appropriate.

d. Set the ultrasonic machine with the proper weld time, pressure, and roller speed (if appropriate) to longitudinally bond the 2 inch wide strip in the middle to the middle of the 8 inch wide strip.

e. The ultrasonic machine shall be considered set properly when three specimens with the same machine setting have a minimum average peak bond strength of 12 pounds.

f. Test the bond strength of previously prepared sample per FED-STD-191, TM 5100 except place the top jaw of the tensile tester on one side of the wider base material and place the lower jaw such that it grabs both sides of the narrow strip in an even manner.

g. As an alternate test method, a calibrated spring scale with the capability to detect a minimum of 15 pounds may be used. However, the one side of the wider base material shall be firmly affixed while both sides of the narrow strip may be fixed to the spring scale. The specimen shall be pulled down in a smooth, even manner as not to jerk the spring scale.

h. The test shall be run at the start of each production shift.

4.5.5 Workmanship. Visually inspect all parts and assemblies meet requirements of paragraph 3.8.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DOD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activity within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory).

6.1 Intended use. The parts covered by this specification are intended for use with magazines or cartons holding 5.56mm and 7.62mm ammunition.

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6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification and of all reference documents cited in section 2 and identified for information in section 6.
b. Title, number (w/revision level) and date of all reference documents.
c. Requirements for submission of first article sample.
d. Requirement for submission of conformance inspection sample.
e. Requirement for Certificate of conformance for each lot or shipment of product.
f. Packaging requirements (see 5.1). Reference Packaging Drawings: ASTM D3951 (Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging).
g. Quality Conformance Inspection, if other than specified in section 4 of this specification.
h. Requirement for submission of inspection equipment designs (See 6.3).
i. Applicable National Stock Number (NSN).
j. Lists of drawings, publications and specifications, showing applicable revision dates.

6.3 Submission of inspection equipment design for approval. Submit equipment designs as required to: Commander, U.S. Army, ARDEC, ATTN: RDAR-EIQ-MD, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000. Request letter of submittal should state contractor, contract number, specification number, item nomenclature and classification of defects or test paragraph. Inspection equipment, inspection method and the frequency of inspection should be submitted for approval to ARDEC, ATTN: RDAR-EIQ-MD, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000.

6.3.1 Submission of alternative quality conformance provisions. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, proposed alternative quality conformance provisions should be submitted to: Commander, U.S. Army, ARDEC, ATTN: RDAR-EIQ-MD, Picatinny Arsenal, NJ 07806-5000

6.4 Superseding.

MIL-B-46367A
w/Amendment 1
20 April 2016

MIL-B-60107B (AR)
w/Amendment 3
20 April 2016

MIL-B-48553
w/Amendment 4
20 April 2016

MIL-B-63992A
w/Amendment 4
20 April 2016.

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6.5 Changes incorporated. Incorporates Engineering Change Proposal R18Q2024.

6.6 Subject term (key word) listing.

Ultrasonic
Stitching
Bond strength

Custodian:
Army – AR

Preparing activity:
Army – AR
(Project 1305-2018-090)

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